exceptions for developing countries concerned about food security and small farmer livelihoods,[277] its postapartheid finance ministers and government and academic economists have been significantly less critical of the IMF and World Bank than their counterparts in India or Brazil.[278] In practice, macroeconomic and financial policies through early 2016 have been largely consistent with those recommended by the "Washington Consensus," the political populism of leaders such as Zuma notwithstanding. This could change, as South Africa, like Russia and Brazil, has suffered dramatically reduced growth associated with the end of the commodity boom and slowdown in China after 2012. From 2014, Zuma and the ANC have been under increasing pressure from a new political movement to their left, headed by ex-ANC youth leader Julius Malema, who advocates policies that frighten investors, such as immediate land expropriation and nationalization of large businesses.[279]

Although South Africa joins in collective declarations, issues of global financial governance reform have not aroused the passion in South Africa, even among senior government economic officials, that they have in the larger BRICS. The one issue that caught fire was the 2012 candidacy of Nigerian Finance Minister Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala for the presidency of the World Bank (see Chapter 3, Case 1). According to South African sources, her candidacy was negotiated between Nigerian President Goodluck Jonathan and South African President Zuma. Okonjo-Iweala's candidacy was jointly announced and enthusiastically supported by three large African countries that have seldom agreed: Nigeria, South Africa, and Angola.[280] South Africans thus were disappointed when Russia supported a different candidate.

More recently, the CRA aroused some interest—South Africa, with by far the smallest economy among the BRICS, is the most likely to use this facility. When Treasury director-general Lungiza Fusile sought the support of the Parliament's standing committee on finance for South Africa's first tranche of paid-in capital for the NDB, he emphasized to the lawmakers that borrowing from the CRA in the case of short-term balance of payments difficulties could allow South Africa to escape IMF conditionality.[281]

Other than modest lobbying in 2012 and 2013 to have the BRICS' development bank sited in South Africa, a goal that never had any chance of success, through 2016 the country's officials did not take a leadership role